



County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Friday, September 12th, Session #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XiE5lc0kMkc
Publication Date	2025-09-13T04:18:14Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Report: Budget Hearings & County Council Session

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript begins directly with the budget hearings called to order by the presiding officer; no separate statutory public hearing or committee work session was held immediately prior.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:37](#) The presiding officer called the budget hearings session back to order. The session opened with a moment of silence recognizing those lost.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Council/Board Members including Brad Pulk (Treasurer), Bill, Matt, Jim, and Kylene Swak (Plan Commission); municipal staff including Elizabeth (auditor's office staff/clerk), Tanya, and Commissioner Steven Brand.
 - **Absent:** Not explicitly detailed in the opening roll, though a quorum of board/council members and financial staff were present.

- **Presiding Officer:** The meeting was led by the presiding council president/chair (unnamed in transcript).
-

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:37 The meeting opened with a moment of silence to honor individuals lost.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not addressed in this portion of the transcript.*
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:12 Treasurer's Update on Lines of Credit & Tax Anticipation Warrants

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Pulk, Treasurer.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Treasurer Pulk provided an update on discussions with two local banks regarding options for a line of credit or a tax anticipation warrant to manage future budget shortfalls.
 - Tax anticipation warrants would be at a fixed rate and non-taxable, requiring public hearings and an opinion from legal counsel (which can be rendered by a local attorney).
 - Lines of credit would operate on a floating rate based on the Federal Reserve rate. Interest is only paid on the utilized amount on a daily basis, not on the total credit cap. Both banks require application fees but no ongoing open-account maintenance fees.
 - The council noted this is an optional liquidity tool to consider for the upcoming year rather than an immediate necessity.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.

00:07:40 County Engineer Reimbursement Status

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Commissioners' Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff reported on an inquiry to the State Board of Accounts regarding obtaining a \$40,000 reimbursement for the county engineer position for the current year. The State Board confirmed the county is eligible for the full \$40,000 reimbursement this year, provided the engineer submits a pay stub by December. Commissioner Steven Brand noted that the incoming engineer, Dean Thomas, is scheduled to start on September 29th and receive his first paycheck in October, satisfying the timeline.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal vote taken.

00:10:03 2026 Budget Adjustments & Fund Calculations

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth and financial staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board undertook a detailed line-by-line review and adjustment of multiple departmental budgets and funds for the 2026 fiscal year, addressing salaries, FICA, PERF, workers' compensation, insurance benefits, and longevity pay:
 - **Prosecutor's Office (Fund 137, Page 18):** Total adjustments of -\$35,799; revised budget total of \$1,625,969 [00:12:19](#).
 - **Cumbrige Engineer (Fund 190, Page 50):** Total adjustments of \$0; revised fund total of \$821,706 [00:14:00](#).
 - **Cumbrige (Page 52/400):** Adjustments totaling -\$90,090; revised budget total of \$2,066,737 [00:19:43](#).
 - **Motor Vehicle Highway (Page 66, Dept 202):**
 - 10,000s Section: Adjustments of \$40,262; total \$234,735 [00:24:16](#).
 - 20,000s Section (Salaries/Truck Driver addition): Adjustments of -\$67,314; total \$1,368,885 [00:28:20](#).
 - 30,000s Section (Operating supplies fuel, etc.): Adjustments of -\$22,249; total \$1,761,043 [00:34:30](#).
 - Grand Total for Motor Vehicle Highway matches advertised total of \$4,809,119 [00:34:49](#).
 - **General Fund & Revenue Form Twos:** Staff reviewed updated Form Two revenues, noting increases in miscellaneous and local income tax (LIT) revenues, an estimated ending 2025 cash balance of \$8,218,318 [00:56:20](#), and an estimated 2026 operating balance of \$3,927,268 [00:57:01](#). Discussion ensued regarding a remaining funding gap/cuts needed of approximately \$2.03 million to \$2.7 million if maintaining a \$6 million operating balance.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed and reconciled into budget tracking documents; consensus reached on tracking numbers without a formal roll call vote.

01:12:09 Proposed Departmental Pay Increases & Staff Recommendations

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Hughes (Board Member).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Hughes presented a set of proposed pay increases across specific departments previously discussed:
 - Communications/911: \$1,000 increases for all communication technicians plus FICA and PERF.
 - Building Maintenance: \$1,000 increase for each of the five support staff.
 - EMS: \$1,000 increase for each paramedic and EMT.
 - Plan Commission: Re-aligning planner salaries based on executive director recommendations, specifically addressing a lag for the principal planner position

- (confirmed by Kylen Swak as a disparity highlighted by a salary study).
- Total proposed adjustments equal \$93,643 (excluding workers' comp).
 - Substantial debate occurred regarding whether the county has sufficient unallocated revenue or fund balance to sustain these raises without depleting the operating reserve or risking structural deficits in 2027 and 2028. Suggestions included department givebacks, hiring freezes, and attrition strategies.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Kylen Swak (Plan Commission Executive Director) spoke regarding the historical parity and educational requirements of planning positions [01:13:30](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Discussion held; no final vote taken pending further data on health insurance savings and input from Commissioner Brand.
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general open public comment period or citizen forum was conducted during this budget work session.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** [01:33:53](#) The board agreed to recess for lunch to allow Commissioner Brand to return with updated data regarding health insurance clinic savings and final financial modeling.
 - **Adjournment:** [01:34:01](#) Approved by Voice Vote to enter a lunch recess for approximately one hour.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-26 02:03:13 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.